

Superintendent Sarah Riddell
York Regional Police
47 Don Hillock Dr, Aurora, ON L4G 0S7
Email: 1031@yrp.ca

March 4, 2026

Re: Hope Gala & Awards 2026— Marking 21 Years of SCAGO's Work in the Community

In 2005, the Sickle Cell Awareness Group of Ontario (SCAGO) introduced the Hope Gala & Awards to:

1. Honour the many heroes who have contributed relentlessly to the advancement of sickle cell disease (SCD) from different fronts;
2. Provide post - secondary scholarships to students with SCD who are in dire financial need;
3. Raise the much - needed community awareness about the disease;
4. Raise funds to support SCD programs, including research.

With over two decades of running the Hope Gala & Awards, the longevity of the event is mainly due to the support accorded by many partners, collaborators, and stakeholders, and for this, we are grateful.

We recognise that you were unable to support the event last year, but with the many years of collaboration between SCAGO and the YRP, we are inviting the York Regional Police to join us as a valued partner at the [Hope Gala & Awards 2026 event](#). This year's event marks 21 years of SCAGO serving people affected by SCD in Canada, and will take place on June 13, 2026 at Renaissance By the Creek in Mississauga, located at 3045 Southcreek Rd, Mississauga, ON L4X 2X7.

Gaining Visibility Through Support of the Hope Gala & Awards 2026

Your organisation may choose to support the Hope Gala & Awards through one of the opportunities outlined below. We also welcome the opportunity to discuss alternative partnership ideas that align with your strategic priorities and community engagement goals.

We look forward to continuing our collaboration and to welcoming YRP as a partner in this milestone year.

1. **Sponsor a Sunday Afolabi Scholarship:** Each scholarship sponsorship is \$2,500 and directly supports a youth living with sickle cell disease who is pursuing post-secondary education while managing significant health challenges.
2. **Purchase Tables or Tickets at the [Hope Gala & Awards](#):** A table of 8 is \$1,150. Individual tickets are \$150. Organizations may also choose to donate seats to individuals living with SCD who may not otherwise be able to attend.
3. **Exhibit at the Gala:** Full booth space: \$1,000 + HST and half booth space: \$500 + HST
4. **Advertise in the Gala Program Book:** Purchase one or more pages to share your message and increase your visibility with attendees.

For sponsorship and benefits opportunities, please review the table below. We kindly ask that you confirm how your organization would like to move forward by **March 31, 2026** to support timely planning. We look forward to welcoming you to this milestone event and to continuing to work together in strengthening support for the sickle cell community.

Sincerely,



Lanre Tunji-Ajayi, M.S.M.

President/CEO,

Sickle Cell Awareness Group of Ontario

www.sicklecellanemia.ca

Email: sicklecellawarenessontario@gmail.com

About the Hope Gala & Awards 2026:

In 2005, the Sickle Cell Awareness Group of Ontario (SCAGO) introduced the Hope Gala & Awards to honour the many heroes who have contributed relentlessly to the advancement of sickle cell disease (SCD) from different fronts. Over two decades later, the organisation is still recognising new and old heroes from across the country. The Hope Gala & Awards also provides the avenue to raise vital funds for the many programs and services that the organization provides, including research, peer support, and scholarship grant program for youths with sickle cell disease seeking post-secondary education

In addition, the auspicious gala event positively impacts the psycho-social well-being of families affected by sickle cell disease as it offers the crucial and rare opportunity of bringing together the community, including the industry, medical and allied care providers, patients, caregivers, and advocates in a social, non-clinical setting. Among many others, past guests of the Hope Gala & Awards include Canada's Former Minister of Foreign Affairs and Leader of the Opposition, Honorable Stéphane Dion; Canada's former Minister of Science, Late Hon. Kirsty Duncan, Senator Cordy, Mayor of Toronto, Mr. John Tory, Mayor of Markham, Mr. Frank Scarpitti, the former Lieutenant Governor of Ontario, Late Hon. David. C. Onley, several MPPs, former Ontario Fairness Commissioner, Hon. Jean Augustine, Deputy Chief of Police Herridge, Former Chief of Police, La Barge, representatives from the Ministry of Health, Ambassadors and Consul-Generals from different countries.

Award Categories: During the Hope Gala & Awards 2026, awards will be given to worthy recipients under the medical, nursing, allied health, media, hospital, volunteering, legislative, humanitarian, and community awards categories.

Scholarships and Grants: Many youths in post-secondary institutions are able to combine work with schooling. Unfortunately, this is not the case for many youths with sickle cell disease, as the combined stress of working and schooling often results in frequent hospitalisations. To support these students, in 2005, SCAGO established The Sunday Afolabi (SA) Scholarship as a yearly grant to support post-secondary aspirations of youths living with SCD. In 2026, the SCAGO hopes to give the Sunday Afolabi Scholarship grants to 10+ worthy students living with SCD and seeking post-secondary education. Each scholarship sponsorship amount is \$2,500

About Sickle Cell Disease

Sickle Cell Disease (also called Sickle Cell Anemia) is a group of red blood cell disorders caused by an abnormal form of Hemoglobin. It is inherited, and though anyone, including Caucasians, can have SCD, it is seen more in people from Africa, the Mediterranean, the Caribbean, the Middle East, South East Asia, the Western Pacific Region, South America, and Central America. Complications of SCD include damage to vital organs of the body, painful crisis and premature death. **June 19th is the Provincial Sickle Cell Awareness Day**, and on June 13th, the Hope Gala & Awards will kick off the celebration of this important awareness day with an estimated 500 gala guests.

About the Sickle Cell Awareness Group of Ontario

The Sickle Cell Awareness Group of Ontario (SCAGO) started on June 14th, 2005, as the Seed of Life Philanthropic Organisation (SOLPO) in memory of a brave young man—[Sunday Afolabi](#).

The SCAGO is a leading charitable patient organisation providing evidence-based support to families with children, adolescents, and adults with sickle cell disease across the four regions of the province. It supports and engages in research, health promotion, patient and care providers' education, community awareness, and the development of best practice guidelines.

Since its establishment, SCAGO has invested 100% of its resources in improving the quality of life of individuals and families affected by sickle cell disease. It engages in evidentiary advocacy on their behalf with the government, schools, and the healthcare system.

Through SCAGO, Sickle Cell Disease has achieved a new level of awareness, and the quality of care for patients has considerably improved.

More hospitals have also received funding from the Ministry of Health for advancing comprehensive sickle cell programs across the province.

SPONSORSHIP AND BENEFITS

SPONSORSHIP LEVEL	VALUE	BENEFITS
Signature Gala Sponsor	\$55,000	1. Complementary 2 tables (16 tickets) 2. Recognised as a sponsor of the Medical Award of Excellence (presentation of the award at the Gala is optional) 3. Inside back cover page advert in a magazine 4. Logo on event magazine front cover 5. Listing in a magazine 6. Logo and mention in social media and all promotional materials 7. 30-second commercial blitz played on the event screen 8. Corporation Logo on Event Screen 9. 10X10 Booth space (Optional)

		10. Includes recognition as sponsoring 4 Sunday Afolabi scholarship grants
Gold Sponsorship	\$35,000	1. Complimentary 1 table of 8 tickets 2. Full page advert (inside page) in a magazine 3. Recognised as sponsor of the Nursing or Humanitarian Award of Excellence (presentation of the award at the Gala is optional) 4. Logo and mention in social media and all promotional materials 5. Logo and Listing in the magazine 6. Corporation Logo on Event Screen 7. 5X10 booth space 8. Includes recognition as sponsoring 2 Sunday Afolabi scholarship grants *Gold Sponsors may select one of the following awards to support: Nursing or Humanitarian Award
Silver Sponsorship	\$20,000	1. Complimentary 1 table of 8 tickets 2. Recognised as a sponsor of one of the awards of excellence under the bronze sponsorship* (presentation of the award at the Gala is optional) 3. ½ page advert in a magazine 4. Logo and mention in social media and all promotional materials 5. Logo and listing in the magazine 6. Table exhibition space *Bronze Sponsors may select one of the following awards to support: Allied Health, Community, Legislative, Tribute, Media, or Volunteer Award.

Award of Excellence Sponsorship only	\$10,000	1. Logo and mention in social media and all award promotion-related materials 2. Logo and listing in the <u>magazine</u> and <u>event screen</u> as a sponsor of the award 3. Presentation of grant to recipient/s (optional) Sponsors may choose to sponsor an Award of Excellence in one of the following categories: Medical, Humanitarian, Best Hospital, Nursing, Allied Health, Community, Legislative, Tribute, Media, or Volunteer.
Sunday Afolabi (SA) Scholarship Sponsorship only	\$2,500/ scholarship	1. Presentation of the SA certificate and cheque to recipient/s (optional) 2. Mention on social media & scholarship promotional materials 3. Logo and listing in the <u>magazine</u> and <u>event screen</u> as a sponsor of the SA scholarship Note: \$2,000 of the \$2,500 grant would be provided to the student. \$300 will cover two complimentary tickets for the student and their guest. \$200 will support administration, printing, mailing etc.

Advertise in the Hope Gala Book 2026

The Hope Gala & Awards, put together yearly by Sickle Cell Awareness Group of Ontario (SCAGO), attracts many people from different walks of life and various media groups. By advertising in SCAGO's yearly gala book, you are exposing your organisation to a vibrant community while supporting research and helping to reach & educate more people about sickle cell disease.

Advertisement Rate Card.

Double Spread	2 pages side by side or separately	\$2,050
Back Page	Full page at the back of the magazine	\$1,500
Inside Front Page	Page “two” in the magazine	\$1,300
Inside Back Page	The “third” page in the magazine	\$1,300
Full Page	Regular full-page adverts	\$1,200
Half Page	Vertical or horizontal position	\$650
Quarter Page	As specified by printer	\$500
Booth Space	Full is \$1000; half is \$500	\$500-1000

For more information

E-mail: sicklecellawarenessontario@gmail.com and copy communication@sicklecellanemia.ca

Thank You!